Tochukwu Cyprian Okpara

Software Engineer, Fullstack Developer, Cloud Enthusiast

okpara_tochukwu@yahoo.com
Portfolio | Github | LinkedIn
Ontario, Canada

Professional Summary

Experienced Fullstack Engineer with a passion for design and software development. Background in computer science and engineering, adept at working independently or collaboratively in production teams. Enthusiastic about coding and eager to contribute to innovative projects.

Industry Skills

Soft Skills: Leadership, Teamwork, Mentoring, Critical Thinking, Communication, Time Management, Collaboration, Remote Pair-Programming.
Technical Skills: Back-End: TypeScript, Python, Django, Ruby, Rails, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Node.js, C, express.js, Nest.js.
Front-End: JavaScript, React, Redux, Next.js, jQuery, HTML5, CSS3, tailwindCSS.
Cloud Development: AWS, s3, EC2, IAM, Docker, Kubernetes, Elastic Beanstalk.
Tools & Methods: MATLAB, FORTRAN, Git, GitHub, Heroku, Netlify, RSpec, TDD, Chrome Dev Tools.

Professional Experience

Lead Software Engineer **Oct. 2024 – Present**
FirstActive365 **Remote**

- Lead the transition of the project from a contract company to in-house development at FirstActive, ensuring seamless knowledge transfer and continuity.
- Actively develop and optimize two backend systems (Node.js & Django) and a Next.js frontend, implementing new features and fixing critical issues.
- Enhance application performance using Redis caching while leading a team of developers to improve and scale the existing CRM application.

Senior FullStack Developer **Apr. 2024 – Aug. 2024**
Media Beast **Birmingham**

- Spearheaded the integration of external APIs and developed backend features for the CRM application using Nest.js, ensuring robust and scalable solutions.
- Collaborated with developers and UI/UX designers to expand the CRM frontend, continuously adding new pages and features to improve user experience and functionality.
- Worked on various projects, enhancing backend applications by adding new endpoints and features using Python and Node.js.

Software Development Demonstrator **Sep. 2023 – Apr. 2024**
Birmingham City University **Birmingham**

- Led lab training sessions for approximately 150 Master's students in Computer Science, overseeing their software development education.
- Proactively identified and resolved issues by debugging and analyzing students' code during lectures, fostering a collaborative learning environment.
- Provided mentorship and guidance to students, nurturing their growth and development in software development practices.
- Led and guided students in the construction of web development projects using React, Express.js, and MongoDB, fostering teamwork and project management skills among participants.

FullStack Developer **Apr. 2022 – Jan.2023**
JOBEX **Remote**

- Took initiative to enhance the existing backend application utilizing Ruby on Rails, demonstrating proactive problem-solving skills.
- Spearheaded the design and implementation of the front-end application for the job platform using Next.js, showcasing leadership in architectural decisions.
- Transitioned the platform to utilize React.js, leading the refactoring process and ensuring code quality and efficiency.

- Collaborated with the senior engineer and performed code review on features.

Technical Support Engineer (code reviewer). **Mar. 2022 – Dec. 2022**
Microverse **Remote**

- Reviewed 60+ technical full-stack projects monthly, and provided technical feedback for students to enable them to become better developers.
- Ensured adherence to industrial standards in every project reviewed, demonstrating a commitment to maintaining high-quality output and professionalism.

Licenses and Certifications

Microverse **Sep. 2021 – Apr. 2022**
Remote Full Stack Web Development Program

- Spent 10+ hours daily for 8+ months (Total of more than 1500 hours), mastering algorithms, data structures, and full-stack development while simultaneously developing projects with Ruby, Rails, JavaScript, React, and Redux.
- Developed skills in remote pair programming using GitHub, industry-standard git-flow, and daily stand-ups to communicate and collaborate with international remote developers.

ALX-T (UDACITY Nano-degree). **Jun. 2022 – Nov. 2022**
Remote Cloud Development Program

- Spent 3+ hours daily mastering cloud development using AWS while building API using Node.js and Express.js framework, deploying services, and managing security, authentication, and authorizations in the cloud.
- Developed skills in the proper use of EC2, Load balancers, S3 buckets, Elastic Beanstalk, and Microservices.

Education

Master of Science in Computer Science **Jan. 2023 – Jan. 2024**
Birmingham City University **Birmingham, UK**

- Evaluated the quality, security, and technical issues in large, complex software engineering and web engineering projects.
- Worked across disciplines to specify, design, and construct computer-based systems both individually and as part of a group, managing project activities under time pressure.
- Deployed effectively the tools, theories, and methodologies used for the design, implementation, and documentation of computer applications.

Bachelor of Science Mechanical Engineering **Dec. 2013 – Feb. 2018**
University of Ibadan **Oyo, Nigeria**
Used FORTRAN and MATLAB to get simulation data for vibration absorber.